REDBELLY DAO · NEW CEO BRIEFING

Christian Westerlind Wigstrom, Redbelly's incoming CEO

Who he is, what Redbelly announced, and what his payments track record could mean for Tokeniser

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How to read this briefing: every factual statement carries a bracketed source link. Boxes marked ANALYSIS contain interpretation, not established fact. A claim-by-claim source list accompanies this document.

1. Executive summary

Redbelly Network announced on 16 September 2026 that Christian Westerlind Wigstrom will become its Chief Executive Officer, starting November 2026 [Redbelly · Medianet · SMB Tech]; Banking Day gives the start date as Monday 2 November 2026 [Banking Day]. He co-founded the payments company Monoova and was its CEO for almost ten years, until 2026 [Redbelly · Banking Day · LinkedIn]. Redbelly says he joins "to lead the company's push into regulated tokenisation" [Redbelly · SMB Tech], a strategy delivered through Tokeniser, which "brings fund and equity administration on-chain for regulated markets" [Redbelly].

ANALYSIS · IN BRIEF His record is in the cash side of finance: real-time payments connected to business software through APIs, with the matching of payments automated [Monoova]. Tokeniser exchanges cash and units in a single step [Tokeniser/settlement]. The most direct fit for his experience is therefore the cash leg of tokenised transactions, distribution through partner platforms, and compliance built into the product (Section 4).

Key terms

NPP	New Payments Platform: the infrastructure for real-time payments in Australia, including PayID and PayTo payments [Monoova · AusPayPlus].
PayID	An identifier such as an email address or phone number that replaces BSB and account numbers when paying [Monoova].
PayTo	Works "like a modern, real-time, direct debit": the customer approves a digital agreement in their mobile or online banking, then the business can request payments that transfer instantly [Monoova].
API	A direct connection between software systems; in payments, "a single API integration connects real-time payments directly to an organisation's software system" [AusPayPlus].
Reconciliation	Matching each incoming payment to the customer who made it; done manually, it relies on payment references [AusPayPlus].
Tokenisation	Recording "ownership of financial products and services as digital tokens", with the rules of the asset programmed in [Tokeniser].
T+2 / T+0	Settlement two business days after a trade, as in listed funds, versus settlement at the point of trade [Tokeniser/settlement].

2. Professional background

Monoova: co-founder and CEO, almost ten years to 2026

- Monoova is a payment service provider. In his words, it specialises "in real-time payments and payments automation for businesses", and its APIs let companies "tailor how they receive, manage and pay funds" [Monoova].
- According to Redbelly, by the end of his tenure Monoova had processed $200bn, transacting with more than 10% of all Australians by acting "behind the scenes" of other brands [Redbelly]. It became Australia's largest PayTo processor, issued almost a quarter of the country's PayIDs and won FinTech Australia's Fintech Organisation of the Year [Redbelly]. Clients included Wise and Carsales.com.au [Redbelly].

- Monoova was "one of a very small group of non-banks" enabled on the NPP [Talking Business].
- In an Australian Payments Plus (AP+) case study he argued that "if a real-time payment is only 'noticed' when someone logs on to their banking portal, the onward payment flow is not real-time" [AusPayPlus]. Monoova's "Automatcher" issues unique, repeat-use PayIDs so incoming payments can be reconciled without manual references [AusPayPlus].

Industry roles

- He has served on the boards of FinTech Australia and the Australian Payments Network (AusPayNet) [Redbelly · SMB Tech]: as Director and Treasurer of FinTech Australia [LinkedIn] and as an Alternate Director of AusPayNet [Banking Day · LinkedIn].
- AusPayNet describes its role as including "facilitating self-regulation" and "coordinating system-wide standards" for the payments system, with more than 150 members and participants [AusPayNet].

Before Monoova

- He holds a PhD from the University of Oxford [Business Conversation · Talking Business · Prospect]; his profile lists Oxford University for 2008 to 2012 [LinkedIn]. As a doctoral student he worked with Robert Skidelsky "at the intersection of economic policy and theory" and co-edited *The Economic Crisis and the State of Economics* (Palgrave Macmillan) [INET].
- While completing the PhD he worked as an economic advisor and speechwriter in the UK Parliament, in the House of Lords [Business Conversation · Talking Business].
- He then spent three years as Chief of Staff and Markets at a large agricultural startup in Zimbabwe [Business Conversation], described elsewhere as an agriculture and renewable-energy company [Talking Business] based in Harare [Prospect]. He has also consulted for firms in Iraq, Sweden, the US and the UK [Talking Business].

3. Redbelly and Tokeniser: what was announced

Redbelly's announcement

- Redbelly says it has spent years building "rigorous, patented technology to support the management of regulated assets", in collaboration with regulators and the scientific community [Redbelly]. It describes itself as "a Layer 1 blockchain built for regulated finance, with native identity and compliance" [Redbelly], and says its compliance work, including Public Digital Token Infrastructure (PDTI), is aimed at operating inside the licensed environment created by the Digital Assets Framework [Redbelly].
- Redbelly ties the appointment to an idea from his Monoova years, that "payments infrastructure must be good enough to disappear into the background", and says he is "applying that same thesis to regulated capital-markets infrastructure" [Redbelly]. It positions itself as "the settlement layer for regulated markets, not just another chain chasing attention" [Redbelly].
- His quoted comments: "One of Redbelly's many strengths is its regulatory credibility. In payments, I learnt that success belonged to the company that saw compliance as a product edge rather than a tick box." [Redbelly] And: "The next era of finance won't be won by the loudest chain," he said. "It'll be won by the chain that institutions can actually use." [Redbelly · Medianet]

The regulatory backdrop, as the sources describe it

- The Corporations Amendment (Digital Assets Framework) Act brings digital-asset platforms and tokenised-custody platforms into the same licensing regime as brokers and fund managers [Redbelly]. It received Royal Assent on 8 April 2026 and commences on 9 April 2027 [Tokeniser/why-tokenise].
- Project Acacia, a research program of the Reserve Bank of Australia (RBA) and the DFCRC, tested tokenised settlement across twenty use cases [Redbelly]. Redbelly says it was "the only public Layer 1 carrying real central bank claims on public infrastructure" in the program [Redbelly], and Tokeniser's site states the network settled a tokenised corporate bond in the RBA's pilot wholesale CBDC (central bank money) [Tokeniser/technology].

Tokeniser in brief

- Banking Day describes Tokeniser as blockchain infrastructure for "the origination, administration and end-to-end lifecycle servicing of tokenised assets", such as equities, notes and bonds, private credit, derivatives and commodities [Banking Day]. It is anchored in patented research led by Professor Vincent Gramoli at the University of Sydney and CSIRO, Australia's government science agency; Gramoli is Redbelly's founder and CTO [Banking Day · Tokeniser/technology].

- Tokeniser runs on Redbelly Network and is offered as software (SaaS) for fund administration and investor portals [Tokeniser]. Eligibility checks, from identity, KYC and AML to wholesale and sophisticated investor tests, are programmed into each asset at protocol level, and products operate under the issuer's existing licensing [Tokeniser].
- On settlement, the site states that "cash and units are exchanged in a single step and the register updates simultaneously, or the transaction does not proceed", a move from T+2 to T+0 settlement [Tokeniser/settlement]. It contrasts this with a traditional sequence of subscription, manual checks, payment, reconciliation and registry update [Tokeniser/efficiency].
- Tokeniser's "API and MCP" let customers integrate it with an existing registry or build a custom investor portal [Tokeniser]. The site reports A$1.2B in issued equity and funds, 160+ companies and funds, and A$2B+ in transactions [Tokeniser].

4. Strategic analysis: what his background could mean

Each point below states its factual basis, with sources, and then gives the analysis. The analysis is interpretation by this briefing, not a statement by Redbelly or by Christian Westerlind Wigstrom, and it contains no price commentary or investment advice.

4.1 The cash leg is a payments problem

Basis (facts): Tokeniser exchanges cash and units in one step [Tokeniser/settlement], removing the separate payment and reconciliation stages of a traditional registry [Tokeniser/efficiency]. Monoova specialised in real-time payments, automated reconciliation and API connections into client software [Monoova] [AusPayPlus].

> **ANALYSIS** The point where bank money meets the token register is where his experience applies most directly. Practical questions for the new leadership include how investors fund subscriptions and receive redemptions and distributions, which payment rails carry that money, and how cash movements reconcile against the register without manual work.

4.2 Infrastructure that sits behind other brands

Basis (facts): Monoova grew by operating behind other companies' brands [Redbelly]. Tokeniser already offers API integration [Tokeniser] and lets fund managers keep their own investor experience with Tokeniser running underneath [Tokeniser/funds].

> **ANALYSIS** A likely emphasis is distribution through partners, such as registries, fund administrators and investment platforms, that embed Tokeniser under their own brand. On that model, progress shows up as issuers, assets and transactions on Tokeniser rather than as public visibility of the network.

4.3 Compliance as a product feature: continuity, not a pivot

Basis (facts): He describes compliance as a product advantage rather than a formality [Redbelly]. Tokeniser already programs eligibility checks into each asset [Tokeniser], and the Digital Assets Framework commences on 9 April 2027 [Tokeniser/why-tokenise].

> **ANALYSIS** The appointment reinforces Redbelly's existing regulatory positioning rather than signalling a change of direction. The April 2027 commencement is the practical reference point for institutional readiness, partner integrations and product scope.

4.4 Industry standing

Basis (facts): He has served on the boards of FinTech Australia and AusPayNet [Redbelly · SMB Tech]. AusPayNet's role includes facilitating self-regulation and coordinating system-wide standards [AusPayNet].

> **ANALYSIS** That experience is relevant while tokenisation rules and market practice are still forming, and in building relationships with the banks and licensed intermediaries a regulated platform depends on.

4.5 Limits and open questions

Basis (facts): Redbelly presents the move as "that same thesis" applied to capital markets [Redbelly]. The announcement does not set out a product roadmap, timelines, leadership-team changes or named payment integrations [Redbelly].

> **ANALYSIS** Payments and tokenised capital markets are different businesses, so whether the experience transfers is a hypothesis that results will test. Signals to watch once he starts on 2 November 2026 [Banking Day]: payment or banking partners connected to Tokeniser; platforms integrating Tokeniser through its API; issuers and asset classes onboarded before April 2027; and Redbelly's role in industry and standards forums.